Hitchhiker's Guide to the WaveDrom

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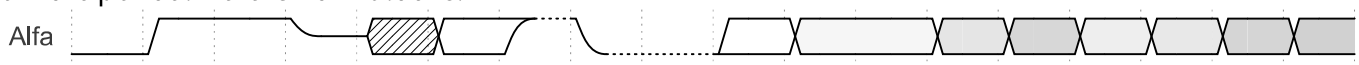
WaveDrom is a JavaScript application. WaveJSON is a format that describes Digital Timing Diagrams. WaveDrom renders the diagrams directly inside the browser. Element "signal" is an array of WaveLanes. Each WaveLane has two mandatory fields: "name" and "wave".

Step 1. The Signal

Lets start with a quick example. Following code will create 1-bit signal named "Alfa" that changes its state over time.

```
{ signal: [{ name: "Alfa", wave: "01.zx=ud.23.456789" }] }
```

Every character in the "wave" string represents a single time period. Symbol "." extends previous state for one more period. Here is how it looks:



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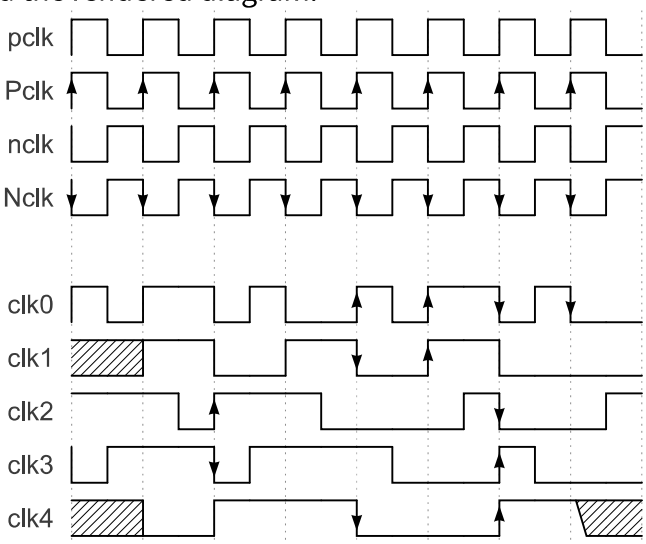
Step 2. Adding Clock

Digital clock is a special type of signal. It changes twice per time period and can have positive or negative polarity. It also can have an optional marker on the working edge. The clock's blocks can be mixed with other signal states to create the clock gating effects. Here is the code:

```
{ signal: [
  { name: "pclk", wave: 'p.......' },
  { name: "Pclk", wave: 'P.......' },
  { name: "nclk", wave: 'n.......' },
  { name: "Nclk", wave: 'N.......' },
  {},
  { name: 'clk0', wave: 'phnlPHNL' },
  { name: 'clk1', wave: 'xhlhLHl.' },
  { name: 'clk2', wave: 'hpHplnLn' },
  { name: 'clk3', wave: 'nhNhplPl' },
  { name: 'clk4', wave: 'xlh.L.Hx' },
]}
```

and the rendered diagram:



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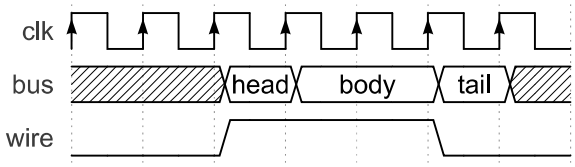
Step 3. Putting all together

Typical timing diagram would have the clock and signals (wires). Multi-bit signals will try to grab the labels from "data" array.

```
{ signal: [
  { name: "clk",  wave: "P......" },
  { name: "bus",  wave: "x.==.=x", data: ["head", "body", "tail", "data"] },
  { name: "wire", wave: "0.1..0." }
]}
```



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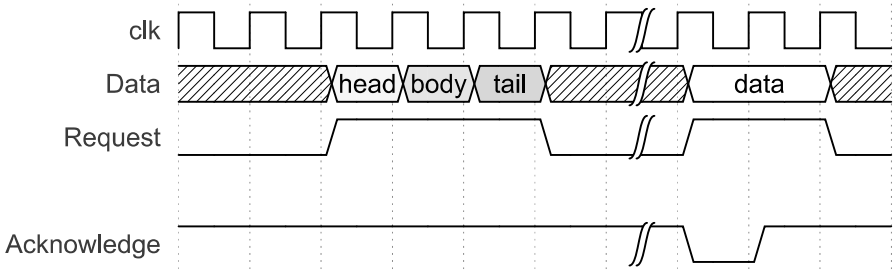
Step 4. Spacers and Gaps

```
{ signal: [
  { name: "clk",         wave: "p.....|..." },
  { name: "Data",        wave: "x.345x|=.x", data: ["head", "body", "tail", "data"
  { name: "Request",     wave: "0.1..0|1.0" },
  {},
  { name: "Acknowledge", wave: "1.....|01." }
]}
```



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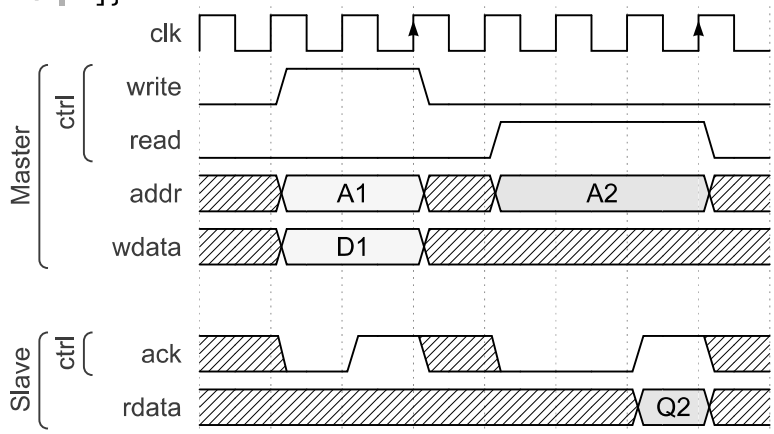
Step 5. The groups

WaveLanes can be united in named groups that are represented in form of arrays. ['group name', {...}, {...}, ...] The first entry of array is the group's name. The groups can be nested.

```
{ signal: [
  {    name: 'clk',   wave: 'p..Pp..P'},
  ['Master',
    ['ctrl',
      {name: 'write', wave: '01.0....'},
      {name: 'read',  wave: '0...1..0'}
    ],
    {  name: 'addr',  wave: 'x3.x4..x', data: 'A1 A2'},
    {  name: 'wdata', wave: 'x3.x....', data: 'D1'   },
  ],
  {},
  ['Slave',
    ['ctrl',
      {name: 'ack',   wave: 'x01x0.1x'},
    ],
    {  name: 'rdata', wave: 'x.....4x', data: 'Q2'},
```

```
    ]
  ]}
```



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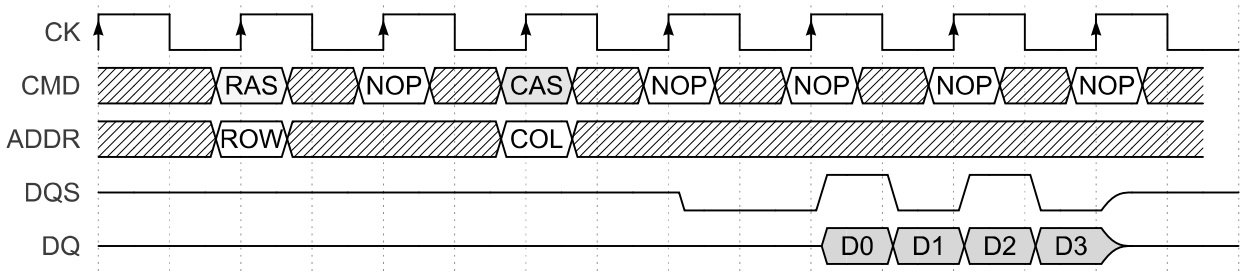
Step 6. Period and Phase

"period" and "phase" parameters can be used to adjust each WaveLane.

DDR Read transaction

```
{ signal: [
  { name: "CK",   wave: "P.......",
  { name: "CMD",  wave: "x.3x=x4x=x=x=x=x", data: "RAS NOP CAS NOP NOP NOP NOP",
  { name: "ADDR", wave: "x.=x..=x........", data: "ROW COL",
  { name: "DQS",  wave: "z.......0.1010z." },
  { name: "DQ",   wave: "z.........5555z.", data: "D0 D1 D2 D3" }
]}
```



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Step 7.The config{} property

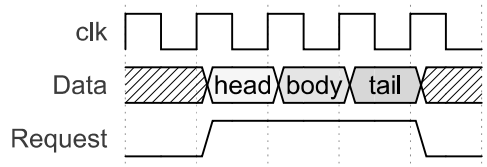
The config:{...} property controls different aspects of rendering.

hscale

config:{hscale:#} property controls the horizontal scale of the diagram. User can put any integer number greater than 0.

```
{ signal: [
  { name: "clk",     wave: "p...." },
  { name: "Data",    wave: "x345x",  data: ["head", "body", "tail"] },
  { name: "Request", wave: "01..0" }
  ],
  config: { hscale: 1 }
}
```

hscale = 1 (default)



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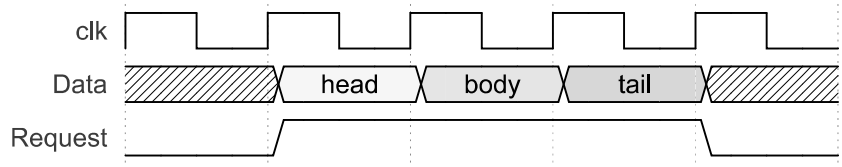
hscale = 2



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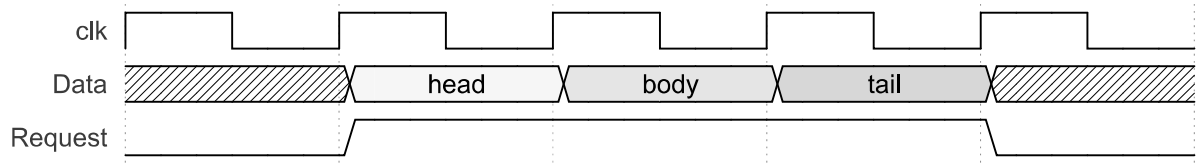
hscale = 3



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skin

config:{skin:'...'} property can be used to select the WaveDrom skin. The property works only inside the first timing diagram on the page. WaveDrom Editor includes two standard skins: 'default' and 'narrow'

head/foot

head:{...} and foot:{...} properties define the content of the area above and below the timing diagram.

tick

-adds timeline labels aligned to vertical markers.

tock

-adds timeline labels between the vertical markers.

text

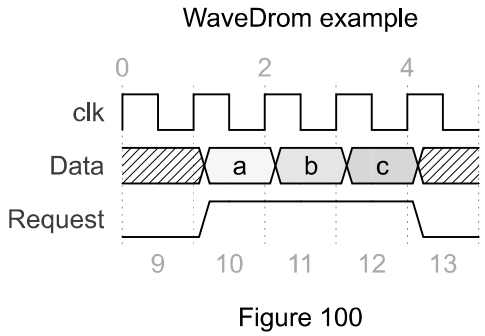
-adds title / caption text.

every

-render ticks and tocks only once every N cycle

```
{signal: [
  {name:'clk',         wave: 'p....' },
  {name:'Data',        wave: 'x345x', data: 'a b c' },
  {name:'Request',     wave: '01..0' }
```

```
 ],
  head:{
    text:'WaveDrom example',
    tick:0,
    every:2
  },
  foot:{
    text:'Figure 100',
    tock:9
  },
}
```



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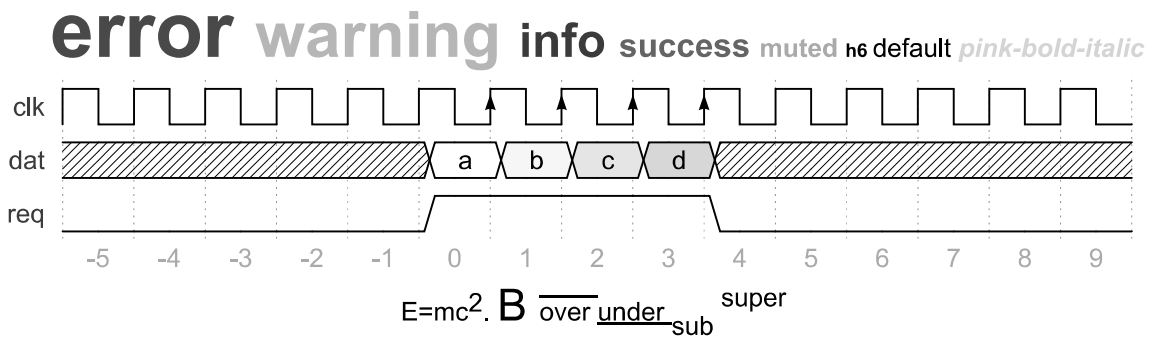
head/ foot text has all properties of SVG text. Standard SVG tspan attributes can be used to modify default properties of text. JsonML markup language used to represent SVG text content. Several predefined styles can be used and intermixed:

h1 h2 h3 h4 h5 h6 -- predefined font sizes.

muted warning error info success -- font color styles.

Other SVG tspan attributes can be used in freestyle as shown below.

```
{signal: [
  {name:'clk', wave: 'p.....PPPPp....' },
  {name:'dat', wave: 'x....2345x.....', data: 'a b c d' },
  {name:'req', wave: '0....1...0.....' }
],
head: {text:
  ['tspan',
    ['tspan', {class:'error h1'}, 'error '],
    ['tspan', {class:'warning h2'}, 'warning '],
    ['tspan', {class:'info h3'}, 'info '],
    ['tspan', {class:'success h4'}, 'success '],
    ['tspan', {class:'muted h5'}, 'muted '],
    ['tspan', {class:'h6'}, 'h6 '],
    'default ',
    ['tspan', {fill:'pink', 'font-weight':'bold', 'font-style':'italic'}, 'pink-b
  ]
},
foot: {text:
  ['tspan', 'E=mc',
    ['tspan', {dy:'-5'}, '2'],
    ['tspan', {dy: '5'}, '. '],
    ['tspan', {'font-size':'25'}, 'B '],
    ['tspan', {'text-decoration':'overline'},'over '],
    ['tspan', {'text-decoration':'underline'},'under '],
    ['tspan', {'baseline-shift':'sub'}, 'sub '],
    ['tspan', {'baseline-shift':'super'}, 'super ']
  ],tock:-5
}
}
```



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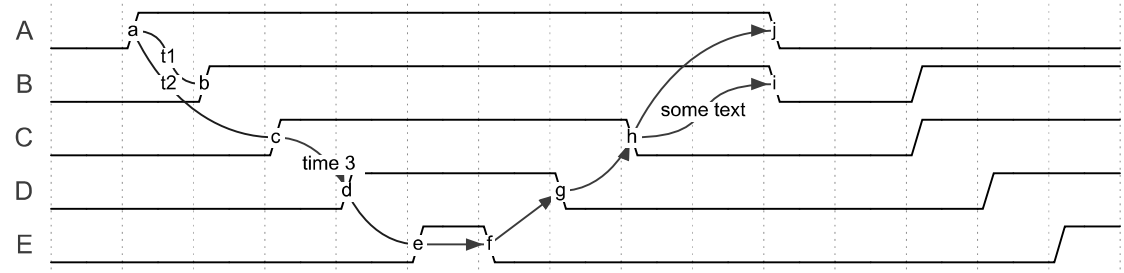
Step 8. Arrows

Splines

```
 ~    _~
<~>  <-~>
 ~>   -~>  ~->
```

```
{ signal: [
  { name: 'A', wave: '01........0....',  node: '.a........j' },
  { name: 'B', wave: '0.1.......0.1..',  node: '..b.......i' },
  { name: 'C', wave: '0..1....0...1..',  node: '...c....h..' },
  { name: 'D', wave: '0...1..0.....1.',  node: '....d..g...' },
  { name: 'E', wave: '0....10.......1',  node: '.....ef....' }
  ],
  edge: [
    'a~b t1', 'c-~a t2', 'c-~>d time 3', 'd~-e',
    'e~>f', 'f->g', 'g-~>h', 'h~>i some text', 'h~->j'
  ]
}
```



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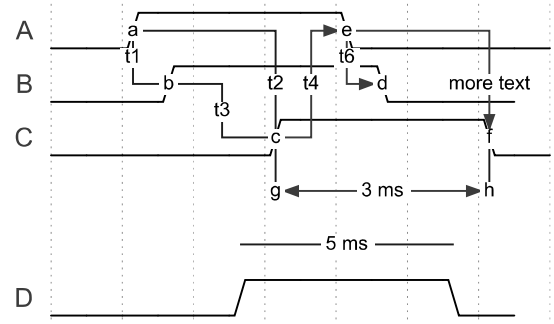
Sharp lines

```
 -   -|   -|-
<->  <-|>  <-|->
 ->   -|>   -|->   |->
 +
```

```
{ signal: [
  { name: 'A', wave: '01..0..',  node: '.a..e..' },
  { name: 'B', wave: '0.1..0.',  node: '..b..d.', phase:0.5 },
  { name: 'C', wave: '0..1..0',  node: '...c..f' },
  {                              node: '...g..h' },
  {                              node: '...I..J',  phase:0.5 },
  { name: 'D', wave: '0..1..0',  phase:0.5 }
  ],
  edge: [
    'b-|a t1', 'a-|c t2', 'b-|-c t3', 'c-|->e t4', 'e-|>f more text',
    'e|->d t6', 'c-g', 'f-h', 'g<->h 3 ms', 'I+J 5 ms'
  ]
}
```



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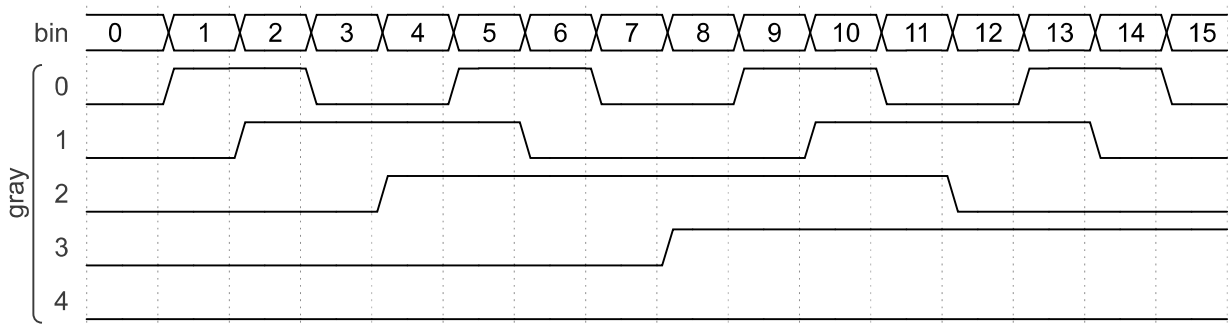
Step 9. Some code

```
(function (bits, ticks) {
  var i, t, gray, state, data = [], arr = [];
  for (i = 0; i < bits; i++) {
    arr.push({name: i + '', wave: ''});
    state = 1;
    for (t = 0; t < ticks; t++) {
      data.push(t + '');
      gray = (((t >> 1) ^ t) >> i) & 1;
      arr[i].wave += (gray === state) ? '.' : gray + '';
      state = gray;
    }
  }
  arr.unshift('gray');
  return {signal: [
    {name: 'bin', wave: '='.repeat(ticks), data: data}, arr
  ]};
})(5, 16)
```


bin
0
1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9
10
11
12
13
14
15
gray
0
1
2
3
4